



Microsoft takes down hackers

Microsoft has taken down a massive hacking operation that could have affected the election. <http://digit.in/nov20-03>



Uber and Lyft lose appeal

Uber and Lyft were ordered by California's court of appeals to classify their drivers as employees. <http://digit.in/nov20-04>



Wicked thin and hard to pry open

While this is technically-speaking 'not a phone', it is ludicrously thin, even more so than the original Samsung Fold and the infamous iPhone 6 Plus, that was supposedly so thin that it sparked up the 'bendgate'. Unfolded, this device is merely 4.9 mm in thickness... or thinness should we say. At first, it opens up pretty easily with no heat or suction required. Just a simple opening pick to the chassis. Later on, matters are complicated due to overbearing adhesive glue and tricky booby-trapped panels.



Turning it around

Turning it around and removing the glass displays is no piece of cake either since it requires plenty of heat and prying. Additionally, there are more booby-trap cables on this side as well and the delicate OLED displays under the outer glass are not protected against accidental prying. Yet they must be removed for even the most common repairs... sigh. The dual displays are both 5.6-inches AMOLED displays (each 1800x1350, 401 PPI). Also, 60Hz refresh rate only since the device is mostly featuring 2019 flagship tech.



Duo everything, including the batteries

With the glass off, you can spot the Duo's dual batteries. Much like other foldable devices, the Surface Duo also houses one battery in each half. However, the larger battery in the Duo is approximately double the size and the capacity of its sibling! There are also lots of obstacles when it comes to battery replacements including generous amounts of glue, Tri-point screws, and one battery is pinned underneath the motherboard. The larger battery clocks in at 10.37Wh and the smaller one at 2.89Wh for a total of 13.26Wh. Funnily enough, the batteries are labelled, "This component cannot be easily replaced by user". You don't say Microsoft!



Last year's silicone

The Microsoft Surface Duo isn't going to wow you with its specs and neither is the silicone it's packing underneath the hood. It's all pretty much old news, last year's flagship chips. Still worth looking into though. You have a Qualcomm Snapdragon 855, layered under 6 GB of SK Hynix DRAM, 128 GB Toshiba UFS 3.0 storage, Qorvo 78052 RF Fusion MHB front-end module, Microsoft X904163 display driver, Qualcomm SDR8150 LTE Transceiver, Qualcomm WCD9340 audio codec and Qualcomm PM8150 power management ICs.



Modular fingerprint sensor

For those of you who were expecting Windows Hello for biometric verification as seen on other Surface devices, you're out of luck. The Windows Hello tech may have been a bit too clunky for this streamlined form factor. The divot on the side edge below the power button houses a modular fingerprint sensor which can be easily accessed during disassembly.



Simple fold mechanism

After twisting away numerous Torx screws that secure the simple spine and hinges on the Surface Duo, the two sides are disengaged from each other and come off the central spine as well. There are two geared hinges that straddle the centre and attach to each side's stabilising bar with screws. The interconnecting board cables go into each hinge housing to prevent being pinched and damaged when the device is folded. It's a refreshingly simple hinge design and folding mechanism compared to the convoluted designs on other foldables.